

India's 7,517 km long coastline, 14,500 km of potentially navigable waterways and its strategic location on key international maritime trade routes. The core vision of the Sagarmala programme is to reduce logistics cost for both domestic and Export Import (EXIM) cargo with requisite infrastructure investment.

Sagarmala was launched by the government of India in 2015. Growing from tide to tide, Sagarmala has traversed a long way to reach a tally of **802 projects worth Rs 5.4 Lakh Cr.** which are currently under monitoring. Out of these, **220 projects to the tune of Rs 1.12 Lakh Cr.** have been completed; 231 projects worth Rs. 2.21 Lakh Cr. are being implemented and the remaining projects are under various stages of development.

In a spirit of cooperative federalism epitomised in "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas", these projects are being implemented by relevant central ministries, state governments, major ports and other agencies through the private sector, and Public Private Partnership (PPP) wherever feasible.

Hon'ble PM has laid down the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat wherein the maritime sector can greatly contribute in terms of activities like ship building, repair, and recycling. As he succinctly puts it, "The country's coastal economy is being strengthened through the Sagarmala programme, wherein along with modernisation of old ports, new ones are being built. We believe that our ports are gateways to development. Therefore, the government has launched the Sagarmala programme to modernise the connectivity and infrastructure on the coast. We are working with a big vision to make the entire coastal region an important centre of development for New India".

Under the path-breaking leadership of Hon'ble PM, government has adopted a comprehensive approach to achieve fast-paced economic growth in a sustainable manner. This has been done through focussed efforts on following key themes:

PORT LED DEVELOPMENT

Ports serve as a vital link between sea and land transit. With an aim to support critical economic activities in the hinterland and to address the growing trade volume needs while reducing logistics cost by improved efficiencies, the government via Sagarmala programme has undertaken numerous projects for modernisation, mechanisation and capacity enhancement of ports. In the last eight years, 89 port modernisation projects worth more than **Rs. 31,000 crore** have been completed resulting in capacity addition of **more than 230 million tonnes per annum,** apart from improving the average container vessel turnaround time from 41.7 hours in 2014 to about **27 hours** in 2022.

Furthermore, the government has undertaken more than 13 projects for new port development across Coastal States/ UTs including Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, Andaman & Nicobar Islands and Tamil Nadu with estimated investment of **Rs 1.25 Lakh Cr.** under Sagarmala. One of the marquee projects among these is Vadhavan deep draft port in Maharashtra which is expected to add container handling capacity of more than **23 million TEUs** by 2040, thereby placing India on the global map of top 10 container ports.

Additionally, to reduce logistics costs by locating industries at the ports- government under the Port-led industrialisation pillar of Sagarmala has completed 9 projects worth more than Rs 45 Lakh Cr. and facilitated the allotment of more than **8,000 acres** of land for industrialisation. It has a potential to generate more than **2 Lakh direct and indirect employment**. A 277 hectares multi-sector Special Economic Zone (SEZ) project, located next to Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) was inaugurated by the Prime Minister in 2014. It is meticulously designed with state-of-the-art infrastructure to boost export-oriented industries in India. Being close to JNPA, the project promises ready availability of raw material, access to global markets, and strong multi-modal connectivity. The SEZ will generate more than **50,000 direct and indirect employment** when fully operational.

To drive efficiencies at the ports and ease-up capital for greenfield projects, the government has taken multiple measures by offering berths at major ports on PPP mode. Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) has become the 1st major port in India to be operated fully on landlord model. Further, as part of its efforts to promote landlord model in the port sector, government has identified 68 projects of more than **Rs. 36 Lakh Cr.** to be awarded in the next 2 years under asset monetization which is expected to operationalise about **370 million tonnes** per annum capacity. Going forward, government has planned various interventions in the ports sector viz. improving governance mechanisms, amendments in existing legislatures, promoting PPP, fiscal support, and financial resilience to enable overall sustainable growth of the sector.

COASTAL COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

The government, under Sagarmala, has taken multiple initiatives in convergence

KEY SUCCESS AREAS

S. No.	Parameter	2014/15	2021/22	% Improvement
1	National Waterways (Nos.)	5	111	**2120%**
2	Annual Cruise Passengers (Lakhs)	1.07	4.68	**337%**
3	Cruise Ship Calls (Nos.)	139	451	**224%**
4	PPP Berths (Nos.)	28	70	**150%**
5	Seafarers (Lakhs)	2.1	4.8	**129%**
6	Major Ports Cargo Handling Capacity (MTPA)	800	1597	**100%**
7	Coastal Cargo Movement (million Tonnes)	74.9	133	**78%**
8	Ease of Doing Business Ranking (#)	134	63	**53%**
9	Containerized Cargo Handled by Major Ports (million TEUs)	7.4	11.2	**51%**
10	Trade Across Borders Rank (#)	132	68	**48%**
11	Average Container Vessel Turnaround Time (hrs)	41.7	27.2	**35%**
12	Average Ship Berthday Output ('000 tonnes)	12.5	16.2	**30%**



LNG Carrier Ship